

Memo Writing

BY: ADNAN AHMED

Memo Writing

- ❖ A memo, or memorandum, is a written document that businesses use to communicate an announcement or notification.
- ❖ While memos were once the primary form of written internal communication in a business, they are now commonly sent in the form of an email.
- ❖ Emails are most often formatted with HTML to make them easy to read. Memos are not always formal but may be informal in the case of a memorando.

What is Memo?

- ❖ A memo is a short message that is typically used to communicate official business policies and procedures within a company.
- ❖ Memos are usually meant as mass communication to all members of an organization, rather than a one-on-one personal message.
- ❖ There are many types of memos, but they typically provide a progress report, ask someone or a team for something, confirm an agreement between parties, or request input on how to solve a problem.

When you should write a memo?

- ❖ For the most part, the purpose of writing a memo is to inform. However, a memorandum can occasionally include a call to action or a persuasive element. There are some instances when a memo might be useful:
- ✓ Informing employees about company policy or process changes
- ✓ Providing an update on key projects or goals
- ✓ Making an announcement about the company, such as an employee promotion or new hire

When you should write a memo?

- ✓ Reminding employees about a task that needs to be completed
- ✓ Making a request of all employees (perhaps related to an occurrence when something went wrong)
- ✓ Communicating a message that employees will refer to more than once, such as a detailed proposal or recommendation

When you should write a memo?

- ❖ Memos are also an efficient way to communicate brief but important written messages to a wide audience within the business.
- ❖ This can include product changes, meeting schedules, procedure changes, policy additions, summaries of agreement terms and reminders.
- ❖ Additionally, you can send a memo when you want your audience to print or save the information contained in the message in some way for later reference.

Memo Example

Heading

Recipient

Sender

Memorandum

Cc or additional recipients

Date

Subject line

Message body



indeed

How to write a memo?

- ❖ While each memo should be written to address its key points and unique needs, there are a few steps you can follow to create a clear, highly readable document.
- ❖ Like many other professional business documents, memos will include an introduction, body, and conclusion.

How to write a memo?

❖ **Header:** Start with a header that indicates that the communication is a memorandum, the intended recipients, the sender, the date, and the subject.

Example:

To: All AU Employees

From: Shoukat Ali Abbasi, Human Resources Director

Date: Dec. 02, 2056

Subject: Adnan Ahmed retirement

How to write a memo?

❖ **Introduction:** Write an introduction that uses a declarative sentence to announce the main topic of the memo.

Example:

I am writing this message to inform you that Adnan Ahmed will be retiring from Aror University of Art, Architecture, Design, and Heritage Sukkur, effective Dec. 02, 2056. Adnan has been a dedicated employee of the company for more than four decades.

How to write a memo?

❖ **Body:**

- ✓ Include a body paragraph with discussion points that elaborate on or list the main ideas associated with the memo's topic.
- ✓ To make your memo easier to read, write in short paragraphs and break the information into smaller, more manageable chunks.
- ✓ Since the recipients will likely be scanning the memo, you should also use subheadings and bulleted lists when possible.

How to write a memo?

Example:

As the Professor of Applied Linguistics, Adnan demonstrated exceptional skills in research and bridged the gap in understanding the Global South Colonialism. He has given his all during his tenure, and we appreciate his efforts in helping the university grow by publishing in WoS journals.

We know this will be a transition for us and Aror University is in the process of recruiting his replacement, which will be difficult, given the big shoes to fill. On a celebratory note, we are planning to throw a retirement party for him, so stay tuned for further details on that.

How to write a memo?

❖ **Conclusion:** Conclude your memo with any remaining information following the body paragraph. This is a summary of the memo and should clearly inform the reader of any action(s) required.

Example:

I encourage you to take some time out and stop by Adnan's office to congratulate him on this deserving accomplishment.

How to write a memo?

❖ **Closing:** Close with your name, email address, and phone number in case anyone needs to contact you.

Example:

Thank you again, Jason, for your dedicated and hard work.

Best regards,

ABCD

abcd@aror.edu.pk

How to write a memo?

❖ **Attachments:** Ensure any necessary attachments are included if your intended recipients will need to refer to other information, such as a graph, sidebar, image or chart, below the end of your memo.

Tips for writing an effective memo

- ❖ Always consider your audience when writing a memo
- ❖ Proofread and review before sending
- ❖ Write a subject that is straightforward and clear

References

<https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/memo-writing-guide>

THANKS.

BY: ADNAN AHMED